

PREMISE DELTA v0.7 (THE TRUSTING FORGERY, FIFTH CUT): DISPOSITION • 2026-09-11

Fifth round. Two independent adversaries attacked the same frozen text of four-keys-premise-delta-trusting-forgery-v0.7-2026-09-11.md. Fable: REWORK, "confidence high on the driving finding and moderate on the rest", "everything else here is survivable with rulings". GPT: REWORK, high confidence. Both drivers are the same call. Findings merged in order of fatality with my concurrence and a provisional in-world answer. Walked with Stephen one row at a time; the Status column records his ruling. v8.1 remains in force.

What this round adds

The convergent driver is again mine: I had Margo cite the letter to a third party. The fix is a form of words. Two of GPT's new findings are better than that and improve the story: Violet, believing her key was used, would change her lock (she does, and it becomes the room's pool-closer and her own trap); and Brad with nine days of knowledge would simply leave (the spine already says why he cannot, and the delta never said it). One finding is a real fault in the forgery's kept frame ("about each other" beside "it isn't any of you") and is answered by giving the instruction Violet's own reason.

The table

#	Finding	Fable	GPT	Concur?	Provisional answer	Status
1	The Day 45 call. Margo cites the letter to the estate's accountant; a competent accountant asks to see it, or tells the sister; the sister learns of the letter and the store on Day 45, not Day 82, and the police are handed four envelopes while Brad is still in the room (Fable, the driver). Margo's competent action is to correct the estate's impression before she hangs up; "in front of him" is a false constraint on a private call (GPT, the driver).	Fatal with front 6; the driver	Fatal; the driver	Yes. Mine.	Margo never mentions a letter to anyone outside the room, and she is fully competent with the estate. Asked about records, she answers about records: Violet's private loan book existed and is not among the papers; the van loan to Brad was on no paper, against her advice; Violet told her in late summer she intended to call it in for the hearing; she has no record of any repayment. That is everything she knows about the money and she says all of it, privately, to the professional entitled to ask. The accountant writes to Brad. Brad answers what he must, because the four have read his forgery: repaid in full, October, cash. The accountant rings Margo back around Day 50: Mr Collins says repaid in full; any record at all? Her book would have it, and it is gone. That is the arrival: Brad's own sentence coming back to her through a professional, with the only record that could test it missing from a locked house since the night Violet died. The estate can do nothing with an unpapered cash loan the debtor says is settled, and closes. Nobody outside the room has heard of a letter. Margo's lock is no longer silence about the money; it is silence about what the money means: that the letter's one kindness and Brad's answer to the estate are the same sentence, and the only reason they would be is that they have the same author. That inference is an accusation of murder on a reading, and it is the only thing she cannot say. Meeting six, asked by Ruby why she has gone quiet: "I've said what I think."	Accepted 09-11
2	Violet changes the lock. A woman who believes her key was used changes the lock and withdraws the spare; moving it to another pot does not defeat a copied key; once changed, Brad cannot enter on Day -9 (GPT fatal).	(not raised)	Fatal	Yes, and it is a gift.	She changes the lock on Day -37, the day after the tin, and has one new spare cut, which goes in the second pot by the yard door; she tells the four on the slip, in one sentence, because they are the people the spare is for (Liam has checked her house for twenty years). Then, in the weeks after the change, her mother is facing the door again. That is the trap she writes from: after the lock, only five people knew the pot, and one is her. So either it is one of the four, which she cannot believe ("it isn't any of you, and I'd know"), or she is imagining it, which she would rather. That is why she writes it down and locks it up for after instead of telling them: to tell them is to accuse them. It is also why her true letter says "only you four know where the spare lives": it is the fact that frightens her, not a suspicion. Brad has the new pot's place from her own mouth; Day -9 and Day 0 stand. And it is the room's pool-closer on Day 15, physical and hers: she changed her lock in October, told us four the new place, and it happened again after. The back door stays as colour.	Accepted 09-11

#	Finding	Fable	GPT	Concur?	Provisional answer	Status
3	The back door. Liam is the sole source for the latch; the trick is discoverable, not secret; a delivery driver has been told it (Fable serious; GPT fatal).	Serious	Fatal	Yes that it cannot carry the pool alone. Row 2 replaces it.	The police recorded the doors on Day 1 (front locked, back latched; canon row 101), so Liam's word is corroborated; and Liam rehung that door in spring, on the same visit as the window catch, so the fault is this year's and the four are the people who have used it since. It remains a narrowing fact the room adds to the lock change, not the fact that closes the pool.	Accepted 09-11
4	Brad leaves on Day –9. He has the book, the debt has no paper, the panel is locked away, her letter clears him; disappearing is cheaper than murder (GPT fatal; Fable serious on the date).	Serious	Fatal	Yes that the delta never stated the reason, which is canon.	Brad's exit is not a departure. It is a death. The deckhand's papers are for a man who has been presumed drowned, because a living Brad Collins with a cash debt to a woman who forgets nobody is a man who is looked for, into a cash economy Margo audits, with a panel question still live in the trade; a dead one is grieved and forgotten. A death needs a grief the town will believe: a young man who goes off Kestrel Head for no reason is looked at; one who goes after his teacher's death and six weeks of the four tearing each other apart is not. Her death is the grief his death needs. That is why he cannot walk on Day –9, and why Day 0 is hers and not his to choose: the month's end is her date, and what she does on the first of the month if the money has not come is tell Margo to write it up and start asking where the van money went, which is the one conversation his exit cannot survive.	Accepted 09-11
5	"About each other" beside "it isn't any of you" (GPT serious). Why would a woman who has cleared all four direct them to investigate each other?	(not raised)	Serious	Yes. A real fault in the kept frame.	Her instruction has her reason in it, and Brad keeps the reason because it serves him: someone got the place of my spare from one of you without your knowing it, or watched one of you use it; so write down everything odd this year, about me, and about who has been near each of you, asking, or hanging about, or in your houses. The lists are, in her mind, about the people around the four. The salt turns them inward.	Accepted 09-11
6	The kind line's tell, "which I never asked him to do that fast" (Fable). Chapter 7 uses the café against a letter that agrees with it.	Serious	(folded into 1)	Yes.	The clause goes: Brad paid me back the van money in October, all of it, out of the blue, and I put it here because it is the least odd thing that happened this year and I wanted one nice thing on the list. Nobody at the table hears that she asked. Chapter 7 is corrected: the café says she was calling it in; the letter says he paid unasked; the two now disagree, which is the lean.	Accepted 09-11
7	The date and the consequence on Day –110 (Fable).	Serious	(folded into 4)	Yes.	Row 4: what she does on the first of the month.	Accepted 09-11
8	The box and the flat inverted (Fable).	Cosmetic	(not raised)	Yes.	Leaf and size to the box. Violet's note to the box because his business post goes there; it is on the van. The four know his post goes to the box and think nothing of the slip on night one.	Accepted 09-11
9	Records not in the document (Fable): the police on Day 1 with N ^o 14; the solicitor on her death; why the room never asks the sheds.	Record	(not raised)	Yes.	Written into v0.8 from canon: Day 1 door-knock, unidentified male, nothing to identify against; the solicitor posts per instruction, confirms the lodging to anyone entitled to ask and knows no contents; the room never suspects the letter, so never the store.	Accepted 09-11

#	Finding	Fable	GPT	Concur?	Provisional answer	Status
10	Margo's meeting-six sentence (Fable).	Rule it	(in 2)	Yes.	"I've said what I think." Ruby lets it go, the second thing she lets go.	Accepted 09-11
11	The first minute	(not raised)	(not raised)	Held.	Unchanged.	Held

Outcome of the walk, 2026-09-11

Stephen accepted all ten substantive rows in one ruling ("Accept all and try again"); row 11 stays a reader test. Assembled as **delta vo.8** (four-keys-premise-delta-trusting-forgery-v0.8-2026-09-11.md) and released to the sixth round on his instruction. v8.1 remains in force.

Provisional verdict, before the walk (kept for the record)

Both adversaries REWORK for the fourth consecutive round; both drivers are the same call, and the call is fixed by Margo saying everything she knows about money to the estate and nothing about a letter. GPT's two new fatal findings each improve the story rather than damage it: the lock change gives Violet her true engine (the trap) and the room its honest pool-closer; the "why not walk" question has a canon answer the delta had never stated. This is my hypothesis; the walk is the check, and Stephen rules each row.